

# The Why and the How of Migrating to MySQL

MySQL is a leading open source relational database management system. With almost 15 years of active development, it is one of the most robust, scalable and reliable RDBMS solutions out there, head to head with other RDBMS like PostgreSQL, Microsoft SQL Server and Oracle. In this article, we will look at whether you should migrate from any other RDBMS to MySQL, and how to go about doing it.

Migration would essentially mean the process of transferring data between storage types, formats, or computer systems. Migrating from one RDBMS to another will always be a complex and project-threatening decision. Choosing the wrong RDBMS can cause major performance issues for your project. It is also not a decision that can be made too frequently.

So the first step would be to select a suitable RDBMS for your project and stick to it through thick and thin. But that is something that is not always possible. What if you are upgrading an old project to the current standards? Or taking over development and maintenance of a project from some other developer? Migration is a solution to many problems related to RDBMS efficiency, if done properly. The first question you should ask (even when you read the title of this article) is, "Why MySQL?"

## Why MySQL?

Why should you choose MySQL over other RDBMS? What could be the deciding factors when trying to select a RDBMS solution?

- **Cost:** One of the most important factors for any business decision is the costs involved. Is the cost worth the gains? Thankfully, unlike other RDBMS,